

Soft House

A smart modular house in Germany has photovoltaic cells integrated in its walls that allow the whole facade to move with the sun just like a sunflower



The domino effect

Want to see what a 10,000 iPhone 5 domino will look like? Check it out. And yes, it is CG <http://dgit.in/15KcsIz>

Work@Tech

early stage of a project when requirements are floated around among developers and testers, the testers are expected to study, understand and remember each and every word of the requirement. In contrast, the developers need only focus on their specific module. This ends up giving testers an edge when switching over to a BA profile.

Certifications – The Entry Pass

Though it's not mandatory to be certified to find work as a software tester in the industry, it's a useful add-on. Software testing certifications can be acquired either before entering the industry or while working with an organization. There are various internationally acclaimed certifications such as CSTE, CSQA and ISTQB available in the market to assess the knowledge of software testing at all experience levels. Let's take a quick look at these certifications:

ISTQB: International Software Testing Qualifications Board (ISTQB) has two levels – Foundation and Advanced Level. If you're new to Software Testing, then this is the exam for you. It helps you understand the basics and the right process of performing the testing. Know more at <http://www.istqb.in/>

CAST, CSTE and CMST: These certifications require some prior experience in the field of testing. Certified Associate in Software Testing (CAST) is like a foundation level, whereas Certified Software Test Engineer (CSTE) and Certified Manager of Software Testing (CMST) are practitioner's level and managerial level certifications. These certifications are administered by QAI. Visit: <http://www.softwarecertifications.org/>

CASQ, CSQA and CMSQ: These certifications majorly focus on the quality side.

These certifications are also administered by QAI and information about them is available at <http://www.softwarecertifications.org/>

Automated testing tools Certifications:

There are various certifications for automation tools such as QTP, Loadrunner, Winrunner, Rational Tools etc. These certifications help to evaluate your knowledge and confidence on these tools and are a great add-on for an impressive resume.

Susheel Yadav, Co-founder of BQurious Software, states, "Advent of Agile methodologies has also prompted the move towards test automation due to short release cycles. In order to stay competitive manual testers are now required to pick up skills on various automation tools like HP QTP, MS Coded UI and Open Source tools like Selenium and Watir."

Education and Training – Crafting the Path

Institutes such as SEED Infotech, Pune hold diploma programs catering to Software Testing. PureTesting and QACampus are two of the few training organizations that provide targeted learning packages; they have specialized trainers who teach and conduct hands-on sessions revolving around specific testing.

To become an automation expert, you must attain good knowledge of automation tools such as Selenium, HP QTP, VSTS, Rational Functional Tester, HP Quality Center etc.

Career Path – The Way to Go

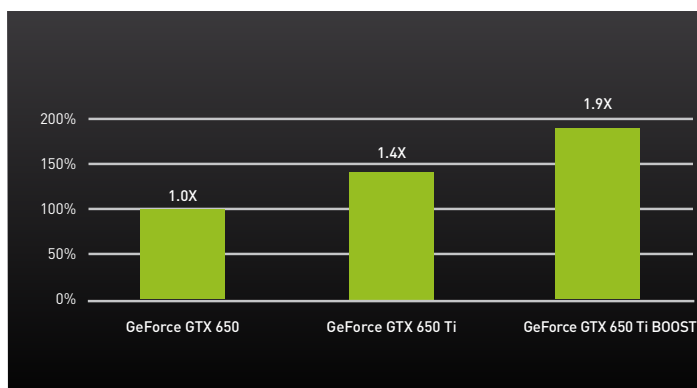
Software Testing has opened up various career paths for aspirants. There are two major paths which can be taken when you enter the industry. The standard path is parallel to the development hierarchy.

The testers are usually hired as 'Software Testers' or 'Testing Engineers'. After around 2-3 years, based on their performance they're promoted to 'Senior Tester' level. Subsequently, after around 5-6 years of experience, the position of 'Team Lead' can be granted, and so on. An alternate path can be the technical path. Software Testing allows you to wear various kinds of hats; if you want a change track after a while, you can do so without impacting your current experience. Here are some of them:

Automation Testing: As an Automation Test Engineer, you will be responsible for automating manual test case execution which otherwise could be quite time-consuming. Automation Testing helps reduce the time and cost for a project, and is therefore preferable. Also it can be implemented in all kinds of projects. Automation testing takes care of redundant types of test execution, which otherwise is a boring and lengthy process.

Performance Testing: As a Performance Test Engineer, you'll be responsible for checking application responsiveness. This step can only be performed when all other test activities have been completed. It helps identify the load or stress an application can bear under certain situations. Performance Testing is not applicable for all types of projects and is done only if the client demands it. Hence, Performance Testers are less in demand as compared to their counterparts.

Business Analyst: As a Business Analyst you'll be responsible for analyzing and assessing your company's business model and work flows, and especially how it integrates technology. Based on your observations, you'll suggest and drive process improvements.



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